Maria Alcantara

Software Engineer (Backend)
New Jersey – devcelestecodes@gmail.com – linkedin.com/in/maria-celeste-alcantara
dev-celeste.github.io – github.com/dev-celeste

Education

Master of Software Engineering – Penn State University Graduating December '28

- **Coursework**: Software Construction, Software System Architecture, Project Management, Software Testing, Database Design, Web Security and Privacy, and more

Skills

- **Languages**: Java, SQL, NoSQL, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Spanish
- **Backend and Frameworks**: Spring Boot, REST APIs, Microservices
- **Databases and Storage:** MongoDB, SQL
- **Cloud & DevOps:** Docker, Git, GitHub, Bitbucket
- **Tools:** Postman, IntelliJ, VS Code, Studio 3T
- **Frontend (Supporting):** React, Angular
- **Other:** API Design, Webhooks, Distributed Systems (practical)

Work Experience

Software Engineer March 2024 to Present
Prudential Financial – Newark, NJ

- Designed, implemented, and maintained backend APIs supporting payment processing systems for life insurance policyholders across the U.S.
- Owned and evolved **webhook-based distributed workflows**, ensuring reliable event delivery, idempotency, and fault tolerance.
- Developed a **fully agentic system** capable of consuming technical features, creating jira stories and completing them.
- Created a Confluence bot capable of helping non-technical folks create and maintain technical documentation.
- Created automated systems for legacy manual intervention services that uses a polling system, playwright for scraping, performs complex calculation, and uploads documents.
- Investigated and resolved production bugs, contributing to system stability and operational excellence.

Java Developer April 2023 to July 2023
Dev10 – Remote

- Developed backend services and RESTful APIs using **Java and Spring**, supporting scalable application architectures.
- Containerized applications using **Docker**, enabling consistent deployment and improved scalability.
- Integrated relational databases using SQL, optimizing queries for performance and reliability.
- Collaborated in agile teams, performing code reviews, debugging, and feature enhancements.
- Built front-end features with **React and JavaScript** to support full-stack application workflows.